

**KAN VATAN**

*BLOOD AT THE ROOTS*

a pilot for an original series

written by

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Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving and joining over time.

These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER:

**HATAY PROVINCE - 2013**

CRUNCH

of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on the rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...

...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH. Listens for the steps as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)

**Baba. It's--**

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

**--me.**

His fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold)**.

DAVUT

**Someone was chasing me.**

She pats her father's back: *sure, Baba*. Takes his arm and leads him up the hill...

...his bare feet trailing RED BLOOD in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

**RED MUD**

under hiking boots 30km south.

**EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY**

A backpacker (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

Inhales clear air. Bends to pick stems of wild yarrow,  
revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck.

He wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his  
cargo pants, grabs his backpack...

...and walks down the mountain path.

SUPER:

**YAYLADAĞI CROSSING**  
**TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER**

A SHRIEK pierces the sky.

He stops. Turns toward the sound.

**A JACKAL**

bleeds in the forest.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow.

The jackal SNAPS at him. But drops its head, exhausted.

The backpacker slowly touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes  
relax. A moment of peace.

And then he finds the wound. A bullet hole.

Shit.

A BULLET whizzes above them.

The backpacker drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye.  
They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT through the trees.

The backpacker jumps to his feet--

Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he--

TRIPS over a root and--

SMACKS his skull on a tree.

Vision blurs. When he looks up--

RIFLES point down.

CUT TO:

**TWO HUNTERS**

drag the jackal through the trees...

...and the backpacker. Mouth and hands bound with rope.

Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a FIRE-PIT.

BLACK SMOKE rises.

MATCH CUT TO:

**BLACK SMOKE**

on a monitor.

**INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME**

REVEAL a DRONE PILOT watching the black smoke ahead. He flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:

Hunters dragging a jackal...

...and a backpacker, mouth and hands bound.

DRONE PILOT  
**Commander?**

**EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME**

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit.

He feels heat on his back. Flames lick at his bound wrists.

One hunter digs through his bag. Finds: water purification tablets. A compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A well-worn PHRASEBOOK - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

**INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME**

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT  
**Looks like a hippie got lost on the  
 wrong side of the mountain. Must be  
 some kind of European.**

COMMANDER  
 (sigh, sipping tea)  
**May God protect him.**

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT  
**Wait.**

The Pilot looks closer at the monitor:

The backpacker is standing.

Ropes at his feet.

The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER  
**Pull back!**

# **WIDER SHOT**

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving.

Fire burning.

No sign of the backpacker.

# **EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME**

The backpacker runs down the mountain. Panicked.

He turns back to look at the drone and--

SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree.

But he keeps running into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...

...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

**KAN VATAN**  
*BLOOD AT THE ROOTS*

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN**

Boots CRUNCH dead leaves.

Sezen walks into the grove, where:

MUSA (15, skinny as a cypress) inspects a fissure in the bark. It's dark and soft inside.

SEZEN  
Günaydın.

He looks up. What? She points to the rising sun.

SEZEN  
Morning.

MUSA  
(nod)  
Sabah.

She nods back. *Sabah*. They're learning. She bends next to him, sees he's looking at the black spots on the leaves.

She takes one in her hands - it crumbles immediately.

MUSA  
Mayyit. Dead.

Musa switches back to *Arabic (italic)*.

MUSA  
*These need water.*

She stares at the trees. Replies in **Turkish (still bold)**.

SEZEN  
**I know.**

CUT TO:

**HOSES**

unrolling from an equipment shed.

Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots. He watches carefully.

She returns to the shed. Turns the valve. Water flows.

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAWN**

WATER FLOWS as Sezen fills a glass. Grabs a big fat fig.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS**

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN

**Drink.**

She splits the fig, hands him a half.

He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit, but--

BACK DOOR swings open.

Davut emerges. Dressed for work.

He inhales. Finds his way to the nearest trunk. Touches it.

DAVUT

**The sun is kind today.**

He looks at the shining sun, as Sezen approaches.

Davut touches her cheek. Gentle. Present.

DAVUT (CONT'D)

**Your mother always said to  
appreciate it before it goes away.**

Then something shifts in his face. Smile fades. He walks off into the grove.

DAVUT

**I'm late.**

SEZEN

(chasing after)

**Baba. The doctor is coming today.  
He said to rest until he sees you.**

DAVUT

**There is work to be done.**

SEZEN

**Musa and I are handling it.**

Davut stops. Turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT

**I don't like his old eyes.**

SEZEN  
We need his help.

DAVUT  
One man is enough for the summer.  
(marching off again)  
Help comes for harvest. That's how  
it's worked for seven generations.

SEZEN  
But the trees are sick.

DAVUT  
What do you know? You're barely  
twelve years old.

Davut disappears into the grove...

...leaving Sezen speechless.

DAVUT (O.S.)  
Go wake your brother.

She turns back to Musa, who offers his half of the fig.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)  
I'm at work.

#### INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data.  
Talking to Sezen.

SEZEN (PHONE)  
It's 10pm there.

Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

KAAN  
11. But Peter's on the warpath.  
He's about to fire my new analyst.

Kaan peeks into an office, boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

#### INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear.

KAAN (PHONE) (CONT'D)  
Kid barely made it a week.

She makes a sarcastic face. He somehow knows.

KAAN (PHONE)  
**Sezen. This is serious.**

SEZEN  
***This is serious. There's something  
wrong with our trees.***

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly.  
But she speaks in English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)  
And Baba thinks I'm 12 years old.

She slips outside.

**EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - CONTINUOUS**

Sezen walks into gusting wind. Rattling the leaves.

KAAN (PHONE)  
He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN  
No, Kaan--

But she hears him talking to someone else.

SEZEN  
Kaan!

**INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT**

Kaan quickly finishes his conversation with a colleague and returns to the call with Sezen.

KAAN  
**Just tell me what you need.**

SEZEN (PHONE)  
**HELP!**

This is loud. He sneaks to the window.

KAAN  
**Relax. I can pay someone--**

SEZEN (PHONE)  
**Money doesn't solve everything.**

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN

It has a pretty high hit rate.

No response. Kaan hears the wind whipping through his family's trees. It settles him. He switches back to Turkish:

KAAN

**Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.**

SEZEN (PHONE)

**He already has one of those.**

CALL ENDS.

Kaan holds the phone for a beat. Stares at it. Then sees:

Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

## BATHROOM

Kaan finds Jimmy's shoes under the stall door.

KAAN

Jimmy? What happened in there?

JIMMY (O.S.)

I'm a fucking idiot.

Kaan leans on a sink. Impatient. Forces a Big Brother tone.

KAAN

You're not a *fucking idiot*.

(sigh)

Just tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)

That my pitch would make good fertilizer.

KAAN

What?

## STALL

Jimmy's on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

JIMMY

Because it's dogshit.

KAAN (O.S.)

No. Jimmy.

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

KAAN (CONT'D)  
I mean why are you pitching Peter?

JIMMY  
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell  
him about the chicken--

KAAN  
*Chicken?*  
(groaning)  
God damnit, dude.

### BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)  
I shut down chicken for a reason.  
Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)  
I don't understand. It's a real  
opportunity. This bird flu is  
crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN  
Exactly, "*the CDC says*". You're not  
the only one who can read. And this  
isn't fucking Fidelity.

Kaan tries to settle. Be reasonable. He washes his hands.

KAAN  
Listen. I know you're new to this.  
But we make money by betting  
*against* consensus. We have to know  
what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous. Whispers:

JIMMY  
And that's like...okay?

KAAN  
What are you saying?

JIMMY  
Nothing--

KAAN  
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Mutters:

KAAN  
Fucking idiot.

Then marches out to the:

**HALLWAY**

and right into Peter - who checks his watch.

PETER  
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are  
you eating our fiber snacks?

Kaan nods slowly.

PETER (CONT'D)  
Good. Because things are getting  
clogged up around here. I promised  
the partners I'd clear some space.

KAAN  
Jimmy has potential--

PETER  
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER  
Find me something good, Kaan.  
(squeeze)  
Before I find someone better.

**EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY**

SNAP of twigs under boots as--

the backpacker runs down the mountain.

He hides in a group of pine trees. Catches breath. Listens.

Doesn't hear anything. Grabs a cell phone from his bag.

UNCLIPS his belt buckle. Pulls out a HIDDEN SIM CARD.

Slots it in the phone. SCREEN LIGHTS UP.

He dials...

This is ABE. But for now, he's known as:

MARCY (PHONE)  
Coyote. You're late.

ABE  
 I was making friends.

MARCY (PHONE)  
 I know.

ABE  
 Civilians I think. Just some  
 hunters by the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)  
 I know.

ABE  
 But there were other eyes.

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME**

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)  
 Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (AKA SNAPPER, height: 4'11") watch  
tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)  
 The drone belongs to border  
 control. They've already alerted  
 Turkish intelligence.

**EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - DAY**

A government-issued sedan drives to the border station.

MARCY (V.O.)(CONT'D)  
 MIT Inspector Mehmet Demir is on  
 his way there now.

**EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - DAY**

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge,  
 revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

ABE (V.O.)  
 You know him?

MARCY (V.O.)

Not yet.

The badge reads: MIT - Counterterrorism.

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME**

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY (CONT'D)

But let me worry about the Turks.  
Just find Brando. And remember:  
this isn't Anbar. If you get taken,  
we can't ask for you back.

A long silence.

ABE (PHONE)

I know.

**EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY**

Abe hangs up.

Pulls out the SIM card. Heads down the mountain.

**EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY**

The road is cracked. The buildings are empty. The orchards are burned. Like humanity has been stripped from the land.

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway.  
HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

Cue AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS**

WILL (40, codename: BRANDO) sings with the radio. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest.

He pulls over to the side of the road. Beside the forest.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE

Brando?

WILL

Just get in the truck.

Abe climbs in.

WILL  
And Coyote?

Abe turns. Will hits the gas.

WILL (CONT'D)  
Buckle up.

**INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY**

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER  
**He doesn't look like a terrorist.**

DEMIR  
**And what does a terrorist look  
like, Commander?**

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)  
**It's been three months since  
Reyhanlı and we have exactly zero  
suspects. We need to be taking all  
leads extremely seriously.**

The Commander's intimidated, but also offended.

COMMANDER  
**Of course, Inspector. We are taking  
this extremely seriously.**

He opens the door to the:

**SURVEILLANCE ROOM**

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering. Watching:

DRONE FOOTAGE of Abe taking down the Hunters at the border.

DRONE PILOT  
**Wait. This is my favorite part!**

Demir sees on the monitor:

Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLDIER  
**Play it again!**

COMMANDER  
**That's enough!**

DEMIR  
**Do it.**

Pilot looks at the Commander, who nods. He plays the footage.

Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions. Notices the scar on Abe's neck.

SMASH CUT TO:

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

The scar on Abe's neck...below ABE'S NERVOUS FACE.

He clutches the door handle as Will drives. Fast. 160 km/h.

WILL  
 Unclench your asshole. I only get paid if I send you back alive.

ABE  
 You sure you can promise that?

WILL  
 Of course. I feed people. And no one kills the breadman.

EXPLOSION in the distance.

Abe swings to look.

WILL  
 Just breathe.  
 (demonstrating)  
 In for four. Hold for four.  
 Out for four. Hold for four. Do it.

Hesitant, Abe tries it.

*In, hold, out, hold.* It helps. Abe's heart rate slows down.

Will pulls the truck to the side of the road.

ABE  
 What's going on?

WILL  
 Coyote. What'd I just tell you?

RIFLES ON THE WINDOWS

WILL (CONT'D)  
Breathe.

Armed men surround the truck.

Without looking, Will puts down the window.

WILL  
*Salam alaykum.*

CUT TO:

**AID TRUCK**

driving away from the checkpoint.

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

Abe exhales. Didn't realize he was holding his breath.

ABE  
You know them?

Will doesn't answer him.

ABE  
They're regime. Aren't they?

WILL  
They're not your problem. You're here 48 hours to do one delivery.

ABE  
I'm just trying to keep track of who the good guys and bad guys are.

WILL  
Look around, Coyote.

They pass under a bridge where:

DEAD BODIES HANG.

WILL (CONT'D)  
The good guys are all dead.

Blood drips onto the truck.

PRE-LAP: EXPLOSIONS

**ACT II****INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY**

REVEAL news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

DAVUT (O.S.)  
**He's worse than his father.**

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR  
**Can you turn that down?**

Davut doesn't hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut's leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR  
**Davut Bey. You need rest. At least  
until we know more. Let Sezen  
handle the grove until harvest.**

**KITCHEN**

Sezen chops vegetables. Listening.

DAVUT (O.S.)  
**This is no job for a silly girl.**

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Sezen finds Musa crouched by the irrigation line. Wrapping a CRACKED HOSE with cloth. Water seeps through anyway.

SEZEN  
The Karadağs have a spare hose.

MUSA  
No. I fix.

He keeps wrapping. But she's already walking to the:

**KARADAĞ FARM**

next door. Sezen climbs over the fence.

Notices a WHITE RENTAL CAR in the driveway. City plates.

She continues toward the farmhouse. Hears VOICES. Raised. Around back, she finds:

AHMET KARADAĞ (60s, weathered) blocking ROB (late 20s, safari hat with flaps, sweating through his shirt).

Rob holds SOIL SAMPLES. Trying to explain in broken Turkish:

ROB  
Ağaçlar...hasta. Ben...yardım?

AHMET  
**Get off my land.**

SEZEN  
**Ahmet Bey. What's the problem?**

AHMET  
**This American won't leave me alone.**

Sezen looks at Rob. The hat. The tubes. The sweat stains.

SEZEN  
You're American?

ROB  
You speak English?

SEZEN  
(back to Ahmet)  
**What does he want?**

AHMET  
**He says there's something wrong  
with our trees.**

ROB  
There is something wrong. Do you  
live nearby?

SEZEN  
Next door.

ROB  
So you've gotten our letters?

Sezen squints. *What is he talking about?*

ROB  
I'm a researcher for an American  
company called Terrasource. We're  
offering our help to all the farms  
in the area. We think our product  
can save your trees.

SEZEN  
From what?

Rob squints. *She really doesn't know?*

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Sezen digs through the trash, phone to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)  
It's a blight. I knew something was  
wrong. Rob says it's all over  
Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)  
Who's Rob?

SEZEN  
The researcher. Are you even  
listening to me?

KAAN (PHONE)  
Of course I'm listening.

**INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT**

Kaan is not listening. He's researching chicken prices.

KAAN  
I mean what are his qualifications?  
(quietly clicking)  
It just sounds like this guy is  
selling snake oil.

SEZEN (PHONE)  
He's working with a big American  
company. You might know them.

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Sezen finds envelopes in the trash. TERRASOURCE logo.

SEZEN (CONT'D)  
Terrasource?

KAAN (PHONE)  
That's a serious firm. What the  
fuck are they doing in Hatay?

SEZEN  
I told you. They have a cure. For  
the blight. Some genetically  
modified rootstock from Spain.  
You're not listening.

**INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT**

But Kaan is definitely listening now. On his monitors:  
Terrasource stock chart. Research on olive tree blights.

SEZEN (PHONE)

**Kaan?**

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

KAAN

**Sorry. Go ahead.**

SEZEN (PHONE)

**They need partners in the area to  
prove it works. Rob's bringing  
samples tomorrow.**

KAAN

**What. No he's not.**

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Sezen DOES NOT like this tone.

SEZEN

**Excuse me?**

KAAN (PHONE)

**Baba isn't going to let you plant  
foreign genetically-engineered  
monstrosities in the grove.**

SEZEN

**Well Baba isn't in charge.**

**INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT**

Kaan carefully considers his next move.

KAAN

**Sezen. These companies are pirates.  
Just let me do some homework. Do  
not sign anything. Do not take  
anything from them.**

Silence. Kaan checks Peter's office again. Grinds his teeth.

KAAN

**Sezen? I need you to trust me.**

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Sezen looks out at the dying grove.

SEZEN (PHONE)

**Whatever you say, Kaan.**

Hangs up. Checks the crumpled letter. Finds the phone number. Dials it into her phone. Thumb hangs over CALL button...

**INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT**

Kaan puts down the phone. Looks at Peter's office. Thinks.

Then throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN

What do you know about olive trees?

CUT TO:

**OLIVE TREES**

emerge on the horizon.

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

REVEAL Will and Abe driving on a dusty, busted highway. In the distance, Abe sees green hills. Beautiful.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY**

LEYLA (22) CHOPS vegetables. Dumps them in the lamb stew.

Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency. As she reaches for spices on a high shelf, we see:

a thick scar wrapped around her ankle. Like a chain.

A truck rumbles into the driveway. She smooths her dress.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY**

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND.

RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.

Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in sunset.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS**

Abe follows Will inside. There's tile floors, high ceilings, and a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)  
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL  
No "one". Just "half hour".

Will grabs a bottle, nods for Abe to follow him outside.  
Leyla studies Abe as he passes.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Darkness falls over the olive trees.

WILL  
I'm helping with her English. She  
says she wants to move to America.

ABE  
Where's her family?

WILL  
The kid brother fled to Turkey.  
Rest of them are prolly dead. If  
they're lucky.

Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

WILL  
They're Yazidi. Religious minority  
from the east. The new Jihadis in  
town have been rounding them up.

Abe follows Will's eyes back to the kitchen window, where  
Leyla's watching. She quickly turns away.

WILL  
But she's not theirs anymore.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on his belt.

WILL  
Fucking jackals.

Abe stares into the dark trees. Silence. His skin gets cold.

WILL  
We should get inside.

**INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY**

A small cup of hardened, old Turkish coffee sits on a map of the Turkish-Syrian border.

ELIF (PHONE)  
**But it's on Saturday. You promised.**

ON THE WALL: Evidence of the Reyhanlı car bombings - surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

DEMIR (O.S.)  
**I said I would do my best.**

Demir, unshaven, talks on the phone. Rubs his missing finger.

ELIF (PHONE)  
**Well do better, Baba. This is my graduation.**

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME**

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)  
**And this is my job. Please don't make it harder than it needs to be.**

She hears Elif hang up.

**INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - DAY**

Demir sighs, puts down the phone. Then pins a photo next to the evidence from the bombings.

Abe's face - from the drone footage.

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

Abe looks out the truck window. To the ocean.

Will is driving the truck down the highway. To a PORT.

Blue Mediterranean stretches to the horizon.

Cranes GROAN overhead. Russian military vehicles everywhere.

A FERRY docks ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck.

WILL  
Stay in the truck.

**EXT. LATAKIA PORT - A LITTLE LATER**

RUSSIAN SOLDIERS move crates from ferry to Will's aid truck.

Food supplies on top.

Will supervises. Joking with a Russian Officer.

Beneath the food: STEEL GLIMMERS in the sunlight.

MARCY (PRE-LAP)  
So Brando's behaving himself?

**INT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS**

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

ABE  
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)  
I trust his incentives. But he's not one of ours.

ABE  
Neither am I.

A long beat.

ABE  
Just explain how I get out of here tomorrow. Will Turkish intelligence be looking for me at the border?

MARCY (PHONE)  
We'll send you the other way.

Abe freezes.

ABE  
No. I'm not going back there--

MARCY (PHONE)  
We don't have a choice. If you get picked up--

ABE

I know.

Abe sighs.

### **LOADING DOCK**

Abe gets out of the truck. Heads for a bathroom sign.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind. Abe SPINS--

Body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG RUSSIAN SOLDIER. Barely twenty. Confused.

WILL (O.S.)

Easy.

Will appears. Hand on Abe's shoulder. Smiles at the soldier.

### **INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

Will and Abe get in. DOORS SLAM.

WILL

I said stay in the truck.

ABE

I have to piss.

WILL

(starting engine)

And I have to keep you alive.

### **INT. LATAKIA PORT - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME**

A RUSSIAN SOLDIER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewinds to Abe's near-fight. He pauses on Abe's face. Picks up a phone.

### **INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY**

The house is silent. Leyla clears breakfast plates.

Then sits with her English textbooks. Opens one, revealing:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings. Everyone smiling. And a map. Their location in Syria circled. With a line that goes across the border...

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)  
It's a trail of death.

...to Hatay Province.

MATCH CUT TO:

**INT. HEDGE FUND - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT**

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay Province. Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

JIMMY (CONT'D)  
I tracked social media complaints  
about dying trees and matched them  
to satellite imaging.

Kaan's mouth moves with concern, then excitement.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Rob and Sezen examine blackened leaves.

ROB  
It's spreading from the border.  
These strains are what, 500 years  
old? A thousand? They have no  
resistance to something like this.

SEZEN  
So? What can we do?

**INT. HEDGE FUND - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT**

Kaan leans forward, tapping his feet.

JIMMY  
Terrasource has already developed  
disease-resistant cultivars in  
Spain and Greece. No public info on  
Turkey.

KAAN  
But?

JIMMY  
(little smirk)  
But...

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo.

"Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

JIMMY

They're definitely up to something.

Kaan scans the photo of researchers in a lab. And then sees in the caption: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE.

His feet stop tapping.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Sezen looks up at the dying canopy of a tree.

SEZEN

Will this actually work?

ROB

That's what we're here to prove.  
I'm hoping you can help.

Rob hands her a tablet with a CONTRACT.

ROB (CONT'D)

Standard NDA. And permission to  
collect data on the grafted trees.

Sezen looks up at the house. Davut's light is off.

ROB

Maybe talk to your family first?

SEZEN

(snatching tablet)  
I am the family.

Sezen signs the contract.

**EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY**

A barrel bomb hits a hillside. Smoke plumes. The aid truck drives away from the lush coast into the heat of the desert.

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS**

Abe stares at the destruction. Will drives, relaxed.

WILL

Worse than Iraq?

Abe squints at him. *How does he know about that?*

WILL  
You don't think I did my homework?

Will pulls over to a CHECKPOINT.

Suddenly, the truck is surrounded by masked gunmen. GUN  
BARREL to glass. Will calmly puts the window down.

A GUNMAN peers inside. They speak *in Arabic (italic)*.

WILL  
*Salam alaykum.*

Will tosses a black bag through the window.

GUNMAN  
*What the fuck is this?*

Other gunmen gather around as they pour out the contents.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)  
*No Kit Kats?*

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL  
*Bring us in and you get the rest.*

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch.

Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his  
mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers. Chocolate on his  
breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead.

Breathes.

Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

#### **REBEL COMPOUND**

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact.

A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.

The Guard waves them through the gate.

#### **THE TRUCK**

is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food.  
Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate-looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby.  
Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE  
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL  
You really can't wait?

ABE  
(walking off)  
No.

**INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - DAY**

FLUSH.

Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles.

A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He  
splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

**HALLWAY**

where children's drawings line the walls. He peeks inside a:

**CLASSROOM**

and finds old educational posters.

Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just  
left for recess. Then he notices, on the wall:

A FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script.

His jaw tightens. The black flag of Jihad.

His mind flashes.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will  
unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens. Hears:

A CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor.

Puts his hand on the door handle. But doesn't turn.

Then, he hears CRYING inside.

He checks behind him, then opens the door to the:

### **STORAGE ROOM**

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against a wall. Teens, at most.

CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

Abe goes pale.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)  
*What are you doing!?*

Big FIGHTER fills the doorway. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL  
*He's lost--*

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER  
*I asked you--*

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE  
*Fuck.*

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

**ACT III**

**OVER BLACK:**

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises. The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

DAVUT  
**Who are you?**

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN  
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut. Before they erupt in flame--

SMASH CUT TO:

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY**

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat.

Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned.

SEZEN  
**Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?**

He looks into her eyes. Still half in the nightmare.

SEZEN  
**I should call the doctor--**

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT  
**I'm fine. I have work to do--**

SEZEN  
**Please. You'll hurt yourself.**

She presses him back down.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

**I'll take care of everything today.**

He looks in her eyes. Then shakes off the dream.

DAVUT

**Thank you.**

She squints at his pale face. Surprised to see clarity for the first time in a while.

DAVUT

**I know I am...like vinegar. It is  
hard being trapped inside my mind.**

(pained breath)

**All I see is death.**

He manages to lift a shaky hand, touching her arm.

SEZEN

**I know, Baba.**

PRE-LAP: STRAINED BREATHING

DAVUT

**I hope you don't.**

**INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY**

Abe is bound and gagged. Bloody crack on his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

WILL

*What is this?*

REBEL

*You can't be in here.*

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL

*Didn't your commander tell you?*

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun.

WILL

*I'm the god damn breadman.*

Will pulls Abe off the floor.

CUT TO:

**INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY**

Will puts Abe in the truck. Gets in driver's seat.

WILL

Fucking idiot. Do you know what the market is like for Americans here?

Will starts the engine.

WILL

Especially with your record.

Abe stays silent for a beat. Then--

ABE

Did you know?

Will drives. Ignoring the question.

ABE

Did. You. Know.

Will glances at him. Then back to the road. Exhales.

ABE

Are they al-Qaeda?

WILL

Not anymore.

Abe groans. Before he can explode--

WILL

We don't choose our friends out here. We choose our enemies.

(beat)

And a choice has finally been made. That's why they sent you.

ABE

Is it?

Will gives him a look. What?

ABE

You could have done this yourself. So what am I? Insurance?

Will thinks for a moment. No use lying.

WILL

More like...a proof of concept.

ABE  
That fucking bitch--

WILL  
Settle down. It would be  
irresponsible to use their own.  
That's what makes us useful.

ABE  
Us?

WILL  
I feed everyone. That's why I'm  
still alive. That's how you're  
still alive.

Abe looks out the window. A burnt orchard.

PETER (PRE-LAP)  
Does this look like a charity?

**INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - DAY**

Peter does pull-ups on a bar. First thing in the morning.

KAAN (O.S.)  
Of course not. But this is an  
*opportunity*. A real one.

Kaan and Jimmy sit in chairs, pitching.

KAAN (CONT'D)  
This disease is wrecking acres of  
profitable land as we speak. And  
nobody else with Terrasource's  
capabilities is even present in the  
region. Whatever they have, they're  
years ahead of the competition.

Peter hops off the bar. Thinking.

PETER  
No offense, Kaan. But how is Turkey  
moving the needle for a  
multinational like Terrasource?

KAAN  
There are sixty million olive trees  
in Hatay province alone. And the  
blight creates concentrated demand.  
If we get the timing right with  
short-dated calls before the panic  
starts, a bump is a windfall.

Peter flops down behind his desk.

PETER  
You sound remarkably certain.

Kaan exchanges an excited glance with Jimmy. An opening.

KAAN  
My family lives out there. They've  
seen the blight themselves.

PETER  
Fuck your family, Kaan. I'm talking  
about Terrasource. How do you know  
they have a market-ready solution?

Kaan considers his response. Peter assesses him. Then:

PETER  
Jimmy.

Jimmy perks up. Kaan shifts in his chair.

PETER  
Get us coffee.

JIMMY  
I thought you didn't drink caff--

PETER  
Get the fuck out.

Jimmy quickly leaves the room. Peter leans into Kaan. So?

KAAN  
I have visibility into the rollout.  
Do you want me to--

PETER  
I want you to silently indicate  
that this will not create problems  
for the partners.

Kaan gives him a confident head shake. It won't.

PETER  
(turning away)  
Then pull the trigger. Market open.

KAAN  
Today?

PETER  
Is that a problem?

Kaan quickly shakes his head. Peter shoots him a fake smile.

PETER

Then let's save some fucking trees.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Late afternoon light filters through the canopies.

Sezen walks through the grove. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN

I'm busy.

KAAN (PHONE)

I know. I just wanted to tell you:  
I looked into Terrasource. And  
honestly, I'm impressed. But we  
need to be careful. We can't be  
test rabbits.

Sezen stops at a diseased tree.

SEZEN

We're running out of time.

**INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME**

Kaan peeks into Peter's office.

KAAN (CONT'D)

I know that. I do. But these R&D  
contracts are complicated. One bad  
clause and they own everything that  
grows on our soil. Forever.

SEZEN (PHONE)

I'm not an idiot, Kaan.

KAAN

Of course not. And that's why you  
know you have to be patient.

He steps toward the windows, speaking quietly:

KAAN

Listen. I can come home next month.  
We'll look over everything. We can  
even meet with them together.

SEZEN (PHONE)

You're coming home?

KAAN  
Isn't that what you want?

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Sezen leans against a tree.

SEZEN  
I'm handling things on my own.

KAAN (PHONE)  
But you don't have to.

She looks out at the quiet grove.

KAAN (PHONE)  
And I know I don't say it enough,  
but thank you for keeping it all  
together. I just want to  
contribute. The best way I can.

**INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY**

Kaan bites his lip. Waiting. Getting nothing.

KAAN (CONT'D)  
Just don't take anything from them.  
And definitely don't sign anything.  
We'll do this as a family.

Kaan waits. The silence is painful.

SEZEN (PHONE)  
Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY**

Sezen hangs up. Thinks for a moment.

ROB (O.S.)  
Everything okay?

Rob's on a ladder. Musa steadies it below.

SEZEN  
You tell me.

ROB  
Well. This one's clearly infected.

Rob cuts a diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB  
Can you ask Musa to pass me the  
scion wood?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN  
He knows some English.

MUSA  
My sister. Teach.

Rob smirks. Sezen does too.

SEZEN  
What happens now? Replace the top?

ROB  
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees  
come and go. But the roots are  
basically immortal.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

ROB  
We're just giving them the best of  
what the foreign stock has to offer  
so they can battle the disease and  
keep growing.

He tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT**

--through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rebel's rifle.

WILL  
Don't be so hard on yourself.

Will ties off a suture. Leyla watches from the doorway.

WILL (CONT'D)  
Most people can't survive here.

ABE  
You seem okay.

WILL  
I adapt to the ecosystem.

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)  
It's Will by the way.

Abe meets his eyes in the mirror.

WILL  
Relax, Coyote.  
(smirk)  
You don't need to show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch. Barks to Leyla:

WILL  
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Leyla steps in as Will answers the phone.

WILL  
*Salam alaykum.*

ABE  
Thanks, Leyla.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call in the hallway.

LEYLA  
What he says?

ABE  
What?

Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA  
"Shh".

ABE  
Oh. He's just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe's head.

**LEYLA'S ROOM**

Will takes the call inside Leyla's room.

WILL

*Sounds good. I'll see you soon.*

As he hangs up, something catches his eye--

Her English book. Open on the desk.

ROB (PRE-LAP)

To home.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere.

SEZEN (O.S.)

Where's that for you?

Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Raki bottle. Two glasses.

ROB

A greenhouse in Pennsylvania.  
Terrasource keeps the lights on.

SEZEN

You trust them?

ROB

They're the only ones who would pay  
me to do the work I need to do.

He looks across the grove. At the trees.

ROB (CONT'D)

You ever think about leaving?

SEZEN

I actually did a semester at UT.  
Hook 'em.

ROB

Texas. Really? Why'd you leave?

SEZEN

My mom.

She takes a long drink.

SEZEN (CONT'D)  
Someone had to come back to take  
care of him. Of this.

ROB  
You have a brother though right?  
What's his name?

Sezen looks out at the trees.

SEZEN  
He has other priorities.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)  
To saving the fucking trees.

**INT. BAR - DAY**

CLINK!

Kaan taps his glass to Jimmy's in a mostly empty bar.

JIMMY  
Your trees.

Kaan's glass stops halfway to his mouth. Something lands.

Jimmy doesn't notice. Raises his glass again.

PRE-LAP: SHHH

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT**

REVEAL the shower running steamy water.

Abe hops in. Careful to avoid his bandaged head.

His scar runs from his throat, across his chest, over his  
shoulder. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

WILL (PRE-LAP)  
I'm so impressed with you.

**LEYLA'S ROOM - SAME**

Downstairs, Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)  
*English.* What a language. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like "appreciate".

LEYLA  
 Thanking.

WILL  
 Right. But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Laughter fades. Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.) (CONT'D)  
 So when I say "I appreciate you", I could mean "I am thankful for you". Or, I could be saying...that I'm considering your worth.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT**

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)  
 And, Leyla - you're worth nothing to me dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA  
 I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL  
 Enough.

She shudders. His eyes flash as he rises.

WILL  
 They're gone. All of them.

Tears run down her cheeks.

WILL  
 I'm the only one who can protect you now.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL  
Do you understand me?

She nods. Defeated. He touches her cheek. Then leaves.

She picks up the family photo from the floor.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Rob reaches for Sezen's hand, but--

BUZZING from his pocket.

ROB  
Sorry.

He checks his phone. Rises quickly. Concerned.

ROB  
It's the New York office.  
(stepping away, answering)  
Rob Green.  
(listening)  
Yes. I'm with her now.

His face drains of color.

ROB  
What? What information?

He turns to Sezen. Horrified.

ROB (CONT'D)  
Who's Kaan?

**INT. LIMO - NIGHT**

DING! Peter gets an email.

RE: TERRASOURCE COMPLIANCE

"Terrasource confirms an agreement with a Sezen Yilmaz in Hatay. Signed this week."

Peter's jaw locks into place.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)  
**That's him.**

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT**

Abe stands under the water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP) (CONT'D)  
**The man from the border.**

Abe OPENS his eyes.

MATCH CUT TO:

**INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT**

ABE'S FACE in a photo from the port on Demir's laptop.

Now, he can clearly see the SCAR on his neck.

DEMIR (CONT'D)  
**I need to see him immediately.**

Demir crosses the room to a WALL OF PHOTOGRAPHS. Maps. Surveillance photos of the Reyhanlı bombing site. Plus photos of dozens of victims. Faces of the dead.

ON TOP: ABE'S FACE. With the neck scar. From drone footage.

DEMIR (CONT'D)  
**Do you understand me?**

Demir rubs his missing finger. Excited.

DEMIR (CONT'D)  
**I have to talk to him.**

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME**

MARCY listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.) (CONT'D)  
**Before they torture him to death.**

Fuck.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT**

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will checks ammo in his handgun. Holsters it.

Grabs his phone, makes a call. Mumbles in Arabic.

**GUEST BATHROOM**

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)  
Get out.

What?

MARCY (PHONE) (CONT'D)  
Syrian Mukhabarat are on their way.

ABE  
Why do you even care? I'm only here  
in case something goes wrong.

MARCY (PHONE)  
Coyote.

**GUEST BEDROOM**

Someone steps in, approaches the bathroom door.

MARCY (CONT'D)  
Something has gone wrong.

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME**

Silence on the other line.

MARCY  
Coyote?

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT**

A KNIFE presses into Abe's throat.

MARCY (V.O.)  
Coyote, are you there?

He drops the phone.

A dot of blood forms on his skin.

LEYLA (O.S.)  
Shh.

ACT IV**INT. BAR - NIGHT**

Kaan and Jimmy continue drinking and celebrating when--  
Kaan's phone BUZZES on the table. It's Sezen. He smiles.

KAAN  
**We were just talking about you.**

SEZEN (PHONE)  
**What the fuck did you do?**

Kaan double takes, confused. Turns away from Jimmy.

KAAN  
**What are you talking about?**

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Rob's rental car pulls away. Taillights disappearing down the dirt road.

SEZEN (O.S.)  
**Rob got fired. Because of you.**

Sezen watches from the grove. Bottle of rakı in hand.

SEZEN (CONT'D)  
**They said he gave you insider information.**

**INT. BAR - NIGHT**

Kaan looks up at Jimmy. Panicked.

KAAN  
**Sezen. I don't understand.**

Just then, JIMMY'S PHONE RINGS.

SEZEN (PHONE)  
**You will.**

It's Peter.

**INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Leyla holds the knife at Abe's throat.

LEYLA

The man sells you. Tonight.

Abe studies her eyes. She's not lying.

ABE

He'll kill you for this.

LEYLA

Then take me.

ABE

Then he'll kill us both.

LEYLA

I don't care. I have no one.

Neither does he.

ABE

I can't protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)

Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA

Stay.

She heads into the hall.

Abe exhales. Goes to the window. Opens it.

Cool air rushes in. He looks back at the door to the hall.

Then grabs his bag.

#### **BACK DOOR**

Leyla finds Will anxious, waiting.

WILL

What's going on up there?

LEYLA

He's scared.

**INT. KAAAN'S APARTMENT - NIGHT**

Kaan storms in.

SLAMS the door. The mirror on the back shakes and he PUNCHES IT. It shatters to the floor.

He grabs his phone. Scrolls to SEZEN.

Then past her name.

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Davut's phone sings and glows.

Finally, he rustles awake. Answers:

DAVUT

**Kaan?**

KAAN (PHONE)

**Baba.**

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Drunk, Sezen stares into the grove.

KAAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)

**Do you know what your daughter has  
been doing?**

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Abe drops out of the window to the ground. Bag on shoulders.

This is the best chance he'll get.

He heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

He spins. Low. Fast. And--

The CATTLE PROD is already in his ribs.

ZAP. Abe hits the dirt. Every muscle locked.

WILL

Careful. There's jackals out there.

Will stands over him. Prod in one hand, gun in the other.  
Zaps him again. Longer. Abe stops moving.

Will kicks the bag away. Checks him for weapons. Then pulls  
out ROPES and TAPE.

WILL  
This isn't on me. I would've vastly  
preferred to keep you alive.

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. Knots them. Fast.

WILL  
You made me choose. This is the  
only way I can survive. I told you.  
(tying knot tight)  
I feed people.

Will TAPES Abe's mouth shut.

**INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Davut sits on the edge of the bed. Phone still in hand.

He stands. Unsteady.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Will sets Abe down against a tree. Runs the rope around the  
trunk. Cinches it.

WILL  
It'll be alright, Coyote.

Tosses the cattle prod into the leaves.

Tucks his gun in his pants.

WILL (CONT'D)  
Just breathe.

As he leans over to check Abe's ropes--

ZAP--

Will convulses.

Falls forward. Gun drops to the ground.

LEYLA stands behind him with the cattle prod.

Looks at Abe.

LEYLA  
You owe me. Still.

From the ground, Abe sees:

The scar on Leyla's ankle.

LEYLA  
Now. Hurry.

She reaches for the gun but--

Will grabs her scarred ankle.

She topples to the ground. Onto sharp fallen branches.

Abe throws his weight against the rope. The tree holds him.

In pain, Will crawls over Leyla.

WILL  
I saved your life. Both of you.

Gets on top of her. Straddles her chest. Weight pressing down. She can barely breathe.

WILL (CONT'D)  
And this is what I get?

He looks at Abe.

WILL  
You think he's going to protect you? He's a fucking war criminal.

Will stares deep into Leyla's eyes.

WILL  
It's true. They fished him out of a military prison in Mosul. Someone to burn if things go bad.

Her hand closes around a tree branch.

WILL  
He can't protect you. No one can protect you except for me.

RUSTLING in the trees.

Something's there.

Will turns to look.

LEYLA STABS his neck with a branch.

BLOOD spurts from his jugular.

And he falls forward onto Leyla.

His full weight trapping her.

PRE-LAP: CHOPPING

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Sezen lifts her head from the bench. Hears:

CHOPPING in the distance.

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

SEZEN

**Baba?**

CHOPPING getting louder as she finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

**Baba, stop--**

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

DAVUT

**Where is it? Where's the foreign  
poison you brought into our home?**

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Leyla trapped under Will's body. Blood dripping onto her face. She struggles to move. Or breathe.

**ABE**

is still tied up nearby. Mouth taped.

Pulls desperately at the ropes. Can't help.

**LEYLA**

tries to PUSH Will's body off. Can't. Too heavy.

The weight crushing her lungs. Then she hears:

More RUSTLING in the trees.

**ABE**

hears it too. His eyes go wide.

He tries to shout through the tape - muffled, useless.

**LEYLA**

stares at the dark canopy above. But can't turn her head.  
Just hears--

PANTING. Getting closer.

HOT BREATH on her head.

She holds perfectly still. Eyes wide with terror.

The JACKAL's face appears above her.

Licking Will's blood.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

**ABE**

watches the jackal LICK blood from Will's neck, then from  
Leyla's cheek. She cries.

He pulls harder at the ropes.

**LEYLA**

sees the Jackal's face inches from hers. Yellow eyes. Teeth  
visible. A low GROWL from its throat.

The jackal's ears perk up as--

HEADLIGHTS sweeping through the trees.

ENGINES.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Davut catches himself on a tree trunk. Breathing hard. Looks around wildly. Then he sees it.

DAVUT

**There.**

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK.

The axe splits through the graft joint.

Foreign wood splinters.

SEZEN

**Baba. Please. Listen to me--**

DAVUT

**Kaan told me everything about the  
American. You betrayed your family.**

CRACK. Davut's axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS sweep through the grove.

OFFICER 1

*They said he'd be back here.*

Their flashlights illuminate row by row...

Getting closer to:

**LEYLA**

The jackal still looming.

Will's dead body still pinning her to the ground.

**ABE**

watches both threats. The jackal. The approaching flashlight.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

CRACK.

Davut sinks the axe into the foreign wood again.

SEZEN  
(crying now)  
**You're going to kill it.**

DAVUT  
**It's already dead!**

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing.

They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

DAVUT  
**And you are not my daughter.**

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back to the tree. Raises the axe high.

Sezen grabs his ankle.

SEZEN  
**Baba stop!**

Davut's weak body can't compensate--

His HEAD CRACKS against the tree trunk.

A sickening sound.

He hangs against the trunk. Then slides down it. Crumples at the foot of the tree.

Blood pours from the front of his head...

...down the bark.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

The Officers sweep their flashlight over:

LEYLA'S FACE. Blood-streaked. Trapped. Terrified.

OFFICER 1  
*What the--*

**THE JACKAL**

launches from the darkness.  
BITES an Officer's forearm.

**LEYLA**

hears the officer SCREAM.  
SNARLING. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 1 (O.S.)  
*Run!*

**ABE**

sees the Officers racing to their truck.  
But Leyla remains under Will. Lungs compressed.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Sezen's on her back in the dirt. Where he shoved her.

SEZEN  
Baba?

Nothing. Davut's shape at the foot of the tree. Still.

She rolls to get up. Her right arm doesn't come with her. She screams into her teeth. Looks down. The shoulder sits wrong. Out of its socket.

She tries again. Left arm only. Gets a knee under her. The ground tilts and she goes down on her face. Dirt in her teeth. His blood on the roots, inches away.

No one is coming. The Karadağs are a field away. Asleep.

She stops. Lays her cheek on the ground. And closes her eyes.

**INTERCUT:**

- LEYLA exhales. Lungs crushed.

- SEZEN exhales. Dirt in her mouth.
- The TREE above Sezen RUSTLES. Her eyes open.
- LEYLA pushes against Will's body.
- SEZEN drags herself toward Davut's body. One arm.
- LEYLA strains. Face red. Pushes harder.
- SEZEN strains. Gasping. Gets a fist in his shirt.
- LEYLA DUMPS WILL onto the ground beside her.

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Sezen rolls Davut onto his back.

She doesn't run. Doesn't stand.

She bends over him. Breathes into his mouth. Pumps his chest.  
One. Two. Three.

SEZEN  
**Come on. Come on.**

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN  
**Baba. Please.**

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN  
**Baba.**

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

MATCH CUT TO:

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Blood pooling into Syrian earth from Will's neck.

Leyla on her back beside him. Staring at the sky. Catching her breath.

After a moment, she rises. Finds her way to Abe.

RIPS the tape off his mouth. Ouch.

ABE  
(gasping for breath)  
Thank you.

She unties him. As Abe rises he hears:

PANTING from the trees.

ABE  
Leyla.

The jackal emerges from the trees. Limping. Covered in blood.

Leyla backs away, scared.

But Abe approaches. He sees:

A bullet wound in its side.

Eye contact. A moment of peace. He reaches carefully--

The jackal BITES his wrist.

Then limps off into the trees.

Blood drips from Abe's arm...

...into the dirt.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)  
**Then where the hell is he?**

**INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - NIGHT**

Demir talks to a CONTACT as he drives through the night.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it. Drives faster.

DEMIR (CONT'D)  
**I said I need him alive.**

**INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - NIGHT**

Marcy monitors Demir's call.

CONTACT (PHONE)  
**That's up to God now.**

She tosses the headset. Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY

He's gone.

VOICE (PHONE)

And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)

You knew the risk. He's not ours.  
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY

I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Zips her bag.

**EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT**

Leyla waits alone. Just her map and photos.

Abe finally returns, with his backpack and another duffel full of supplies (looted from Will's compound).

LEYLA

Where now?

ABE

Your brother.

Leyla shakes her head gravely.

ABE

He's alive.

She stops. Can't speak.

ABE

I swear. Will told me. He's  
somewhere in Turkey. I'll take you.  
If you know where he was going.

Slowly, she pulls out the map. Fumbles to open it. Shows him.

LEYLA

Hatay.

ABE

Then we better get over the border  
before daybreak.

He starts walking toward the dark mountains.

Before she follows, she looks at the family photo.

LEYLA  
I'm coming...

Touches her brother's face.

MATCH CUT TO:

**MUSA**

hides behind a tree.

LEYLA (V.O.) (CONT'D)  
...Musa.

Terrified. But the fight is over.

Sezen is just sitting there. Davut's body in her arms.

She looks up. Eye contact. *He saw everything.*

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Then realizes: it's Davut's phone.

**INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT**

Kaan waits in line for the Turkish Airlines desk. Calling Davut. Finally, the call is answered.

KAAN  
**Baba. I'm on my way home.**

No response. But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove. It settles him.

KAAN  
**We can fix this.**

SEZEN (PHONE)  
**No. We can't.**

**EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN**

Sezen hangs up Davut's phone.

Then holds him tight in her lap.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response...

...and for the first time this year...

...the branches seem to grow.

HOWLING in the distance--

CUT TO BLACK.